

Case Study

Sunny Truck Driving School — Custom Management Application on Zoho Creator

1. Client Background

The client operates in the Driving School and Driver Training industry. They sought a custom application primarily to manage and streamline their internal operations, including student management, lesson scheduling, instructor coordination, road test tracking, invoicing, and overall administrative processes. The solution was intended to serve as a centralized platform for administrators, instructors, and students, improving operational efficiency, communication, and visibility across the organization.

2. Objective

The client wanted an application that enables efficient management of students, lessons, and road tests through a centralized platform. The goal was to streamline student onboarding, lesson scheduling, instructor assignments, road test management, and overall operational processes.

3. Proposed Solution

The solution was built on Zoho Creator as the core application platform, comprising the following components:

- **Admin Portal** — For managing students, instructors, lesson schedules, road tests, reporting, and overall operations.
- **Instructor Portal** — For instructors to view assigned lessons, manage schedules, update student progress, and handle road test-related activities.
- **Student Portal** — For students to access their lesson schedules, track progress, and view road test information.
- **Zoho Books Integration** — For invoicing, payment tracking, and financial management.
- **Mobile Applications (Android & iOS)** — Dedicated apps for instructors, enabling them to access schedules, update lesson information, and manage student activities directly from the field, eliminating the need for desktop systems while on the go.

This solution provides a complete ecosystem for managing student training operations, improving efficiency, visibility, and communication across administrators, instructors, and students.

4. Project Overview

The project involved development of a comprehensive Driving School Management System using Zoho Creator to streamline and automate the client's day-to-day operations, serving as a centralized platform for managing students, instructors, lesson schedules, road tests, and administrative activities.

Dedicated portals were built for Administrators, Instructors, and Students, ensuring role-based access and an optimized experience for each stakeholder: administrators manage operations, instructors view and update lesson-related information, and students access their schedules, progress, and road test details.

Zoho Books was integrated to manage invoicing, payments, and financial records. To support instructors working in the field, dedicated Android and iOS mobile applications were provided, allowing them to access schedules, update lesson statuses, track student progress, and perform required tasks without needing access to a desktop system.

Overall, the project aimed to improve operational efficiency, reduce manual processes, enhance communication between stakeholders, and provide a scalable digital platform for managing the entire driving school workflow.

5. Core System Modules (Historical Data Import Design)

The application was structured around a set of interconnected modules, each with a defined purpose and, where applicable, historical data migrated from the client's previous software.

1. Student Module

Purpose: Serves as the central repository for all student information.

- Data Migration: Student data imported from a CSV file exported from the previous software; existing student records migrated into the Student form in Zoho Creator.
- Key Features: Stores complete student information; serves as the primary lookup module for all other forms; maintains relationships with packages, lessons, invoices, check-ins, and road tests.

2. All Packages Module

Purpose: Stores all available training packages offered by the organization.

- Data Source: Package information synchronized from Zoho Books and automatically reflects updates made there.
- Features: Displays package details; allows package selection during package purchase; maintains synchronization with Zoho Books.

3. Attempts Module (Road Tests)

Purpose: Records all road test attempts taken by students.

- Required Fields: Student (lookup to Student module), Road Test Date, Road Test Time, Road Test Location.

4. Check-Ins Module

Purpose: Records student attendance for scheduled lessons.

- Data Migration: Existing attendance/check-in records imported.
- Required Fields: Student (lookup to Student module), Check-In Date, Check-In Time.
- Features: Maintains attendance history; allows instructors to mark attendance; generates attendance reports.

5. Package Purchase Module

Purpose: Records every package purchased by a student.

- Required Fields: Student (lookup to Student module), Package Details (lookup to Package module), Purchase Date.

- Zoho Books Integration on Purchase: (1) Automatically create an Invoice in Zoho Books; (2) Store the Zoho Books Invoice ID in Zoho Creator; (3) Create a corresponding Invoice record in Zoho Creator; (4) Link the Package Purchase record with both invoices using lookup fields; (5) Maintain synchronization between Zoho Creator and Zoho Books.
- Relationship Flow: Student → Package Purchase → Zoho Books Invoice → Zoho Creator Invoice.

6. Schedule Lessons Module

Purpose: Used to schedule driving lessons for students with instructors.

- Required Fields: Student (lookup to Student module), Instructor (lookup to Instructor module), Lesson Date.
- Features: Assign instructors to students; schedule lessons for specific dates; allow multiple lessons per student; maintain lesson history.

Module Relationships

The modules were interconnected using lookup fields to ensure proper data relationships:

- Student → Package Purchases
- Student → Scheduled Lessons
- Student → Road Test Attempts
- Student → Check-Ins
- Package Purchase → Package
- Package Purchase → Zoho Creator Invoice
- Package Purchase → Zoho Books Invoice

Data Import Requirements

The following historical data was imported from the previous software, preserving data integrity and establishing correct relationships with the respective modules:

- Student Records
- Road Test Attempts
- Check-In Records
- Package Purchases

Zoho Books Integration Requirements

The application integrates with Zoho Books for package and invoice management:

- **Package Synchronization** — Fetch all available packages from Zoho Books and keep package information synchronized.

- **Invoice Automation** — When a package purchase is created: generate an invoice in Zoho Books; generate a corresponding invoice record in Zoho Creator; link both invoice records using lookup fields; associate the invoices with the related package purchase and student.

6. Application Widgets and Reports

The application comprises 19 widgets, each tied to specific reports, covering active production features as well as earlier/test versions retained in the build. Status is shown as documented (In Use / Not in Use).

#	Widget	Status	Purpose / Reports Used
1	AddEditAttempts	In Use	Button in student report to view/add road test attempts. Report: All_Attempts1.
2	Student_Availability	Not in Use	Shows student availability for lessons and attempts. Report: All_Student_Availabilities.
3	schedule_lessons	Not in Use	Old widget created during the first phase.
4	Student Search	In Use	Allows searching all students; admin can view and edit student records. Report: All_Students.
5	InstructorPortal	Not in Use	Old mobile app discussed in the first meeting.
6	Test schedule Lessons	Not in Use	Used only for testing new UI.
7	Dashboard	Not in Use	Old dashboard discussed in the first meeting.
8	All_Road_tests	Not in Use	Created for the road test sheet.
9	sheduled_lessons_ins tructor	In Use	Button in Instructor report to check the daily sign-in sheet of the instructor. Reports: All_Students, All_Schedule_Lessons.
10	updated_lessons_schedule	Not in Use	Created with updates to the schedule lesson page.
11	New_Dashboard	In Use	Admin dashboard. Reports: All_Students, All_Schedule_Lessons, All_Attendances, Attempts1, All_Road_Test_Attempts, All_Packages, All_Package_Purchases1, All_Instructors, All_Branches.
12	new_mobile_UI	In Use	Complete Android/iOS mobile application for instructors to view students and scheduled lessons, give feedback, and mark attendance. Reports: All_Road_Test_Attempts, All_Students, All_Instructors, All_Feedback, All_Schedule_Lessons, All_Attendances.
13	NewSheduleLessons Updated	In Use	Schedules lessons for students and assigns them to instructors. Reports: All_Students, All_Schedule_Lessons, All_Instructors, All_Time_Slots, All_Package_Purchases1.
14	NewAllRoadTest	In Use	Used on the Road Test Sheet page to divide students into lanes for road tests by class. Reports: All_Road_Test_Attempts, All_Students.
15	Student_dashboard	In Use	Dashboard for the student portal. Reports: All_Students, All_Schedule_Lessons, All_Attendances, Attempts1, All_Package_Purchases1.

#	Widget	Status	Purpose / Reports Used
1 6	Feedback	In Use	Lets students view feedback given by instructors. Reports: All_Students, All_Feedback, All_Road_Test_Attempts, All_Schedule_Lessons.
1 7	Attendance Sign	Not in Use	Created to test the signature option in mobile.
1 8	Feedback_Admin	In Use	Shows admin the feedback given by instructors to students. Reports: All_Students, All_Feedback, All_Road_Test_Attempts, All_Schedule_Lessons.
1 9	No_Show	In Use	Shows students who had lessons scheduled but never checked in. Reports: All_Students, All_Schedule_Lessons, All_Attendances.

7. Tasks / Change Requests Raised by the Client

Three items were documented as open tasks or change requests (CRs) requiring review:

1. Manage Funding Program — Clarification Request

The client requested clarification on the purpose and functionality of the "Manage Funding Program" feature, asking for a review of the implementation and an explanation of what this feature is intended to do.

2. Payment Recording — Submission Delay and Window Behavior

The client reported that when recording a payment against a student and submitting it, the submission takes some time to process. After the submission is completed, the payment window remains open. This behavior needs investigation to verify whether it is functioning as intended or if an issue exists.

3. Lesson Choice Field — Mandatory Field Review

The client reported that the Lesson Choice field appears to be required for the application to function correctly, because if this field is skipped, the student cannot be found in the Schedule Lessons section. However, the field is currently not marked as mandatory. This behavior needs to be reviewed and the requirement verified.

This case study is compiled solely from the project brief document provided for Sunny Truck Driving School's Zoho Creator application ("Sunny Truck Service").